

pool installed, but that a new pool would mean the family would not be able to send the son to Cornell.

Today the son, Carl, is a Cornell graduate. No, his folks never had a swimming pool installed. What will happen when Carl's children ask about their father's proclivity to frugality? Will he be able to defend his purchasing orientation and his frugal nature in general? The answer to this question is reflected in the results given in [Table 4-4](#). Used vehicle-prone shoppers are significantly more likely to report the following:

♦ My parents are [were] very frugal.

Once a member of the used vehicle-prone shopper group told us about his frugal habits. He explained that his parents were farmers:

My family in Nebraska understood the value of a dollar. Dad used to say seeds are a lot like dollars. You can eat the seeds or sow them. But when you would see what seeds turned into ... ten-foot-high corn ... you don't want to waste them. Consume them or plant them. I always get a kick out of watching things grow.

This man derived considerable enjoyment in his nondescript, four-door, three-year-old American-made sedan. He believed that his vehicle never revealed to the public that he was very affluent. Nor, according to him, would it ever encourage thieves to follow him home to burglarize his property. He often referred to his car as "the last one that would ever be stolen out of the airport parking lot!"

FRUGALITY TRANSLATES INTO WEALTH

Being frugal is a major reason members of the used vehicle-prone group are wealthy. Being frugal provides them with a dollar base to invest. In fact, they invest a significantly larger portion of their annual income than do any of the other types of vehicle buyers. This also applies to their contributions to pension/annuity programs. As you may have already predicted, the used vehicle-prone shopper group also contains the